THE HERO'S QUITE CALL

INTRODUCTION

Brief overview of the game

In this light-hearted adventure game, you play as a legendary hero known for slaying beasts and saving kingdoms. But this time, the quest isn't about violence or glory, it's about rebuilding a struggling village through a series of unexpected, everyday tasks. What begins as a reluctant favor turns into a heartfelt journey of growth, community, and perspective.

What makes it unique

A story-driven puzzle adventure that flips the traditional hero trope. Instead of fighting monsters, you team up with them. You help solve problems, delegate tasks, and uncover the truth behind the village's struggles. It offers a cozy and thoughtful twist on classic RPG mechanics, where the challenge lies in connection and understanding rather than combat.

This project is a passion piece blending storytelling and puzzle design.

THE STORY

In a kingdom where heroic deeds are a daily occurrence, our protagonist is nothing short of a living legend. He has slain every imaginable beast, saved hundreds of lives, and mastered every known martial art (though, admittedly, there aren't that many yet).

When he receives a quest to aid a village in desperate need of a hero, he eagerly sets out to slay the creature tormenting them. But upon arriving, he discovers there is no beast at all. Instead, the town is struggling to survive and on the verge of abandonment. What they truly need is someone to help them rebuild.

Reluctantly, the hero takes on task after mundane task, far beneath his skill and pay grade. However, his pride won't allow him to abandon a quest.

As the story unfolds, the village slowly transforms, and so do its people. The overwhelming workload once carried by exhausted villagers is gradually picked up by so-called "monsters" who excel in their respective roles.

Through these unexpected alliances, the hero comes to understand the value of everyday help, the power of community, and the importance of seeking understanding before casting judgment.

CHARACTERS

The hero

The legendary hero is determined to prove to the world that his story is the greatest.

But instead of finding an epic quest, he stumbles upon a plethora of everyday tasks and mundane chores.

Despite being hesitant at first, he is determined not to fail this seemingly easy task. Throughout the story, he faces challenges he isn't trained in. His usually violent approach fails him, and he is forced to take on a new perspective. He learns that being a monster doesn't always mean ill intent, and that listening and talking can be sharper tools than any sword. Due to his dedication to the task, he starts to modify his gear in ways that aid him in everyday life. He lays down piece by piece to fulfill his assignment.

The mage/cow

A powerful spellcaster—though not immune to magical mishaps. After a botched incantation, she accidentally transforms herself into a cow. Now hoof-bound and thumb-less, she reluctantly relies on the hero for assistance. Sleepier than she is powerful (and she's very powerful), she balances her duties as the town mage with her desire for endless naps. Her magical expertise remains intact, even if her body mooooved on.

The bard

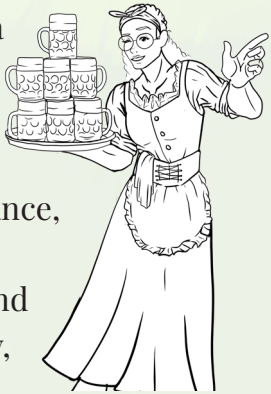
An idealistic musician who plays a plethora of instruments. With his hands and mouth full while performing, he has to abstain from actually singing, despite being an excellent lyricist. He often gets hired by the innkeeper to entertain the guests, but could really do with some supporting musicians by his side. It is rumored that all of his songs are about the seamstress.

The seamstress

A skilled seamstress, handy with many tools. She helps the hero modify his gear to fit his tasks. At times a little awkward, she still finds the courage to stand up for her friend in difficult situations. She loves making personalized gifts for her friends and neighbors.

Even though she has a lot on her mind, she still makes it a priority to think about the needs of her fellow villagers and gives the hero quests regarding those needs.

The innkeeper



A cheery, tall woman, rumored to be a half-giant. She runs the inn with an iron fist. No sleeping past dawn on her watch. As the only place in the town to stay the night and get sustenance, you're bound to run into her on your travels. She never lacks enthusiasm and is always up for some physical activity, even on her busiest days.

Due to a lack of workers, she is putting too much on her plate and is in need of a good ale-runner to serve her guests.

The artisan

A talented artist with an alternative personal style. After a freak accident, which was her birth, she was perfectly normal. Then, when she was getting a new piercing, she ended up with scissor hands due to a miscommunication. Afterwards, she had trouble adapting to her new grippers. She tried multiple professions but found her calling in hairdressing, utilizing her shears and blossoming as someone who knows every rumor and bit of information. She opens a salon called “The Teashop.” She serves as an information source for the hero.

The firefighter

Despite being very young, she is the only fully trained firefighter, due to her peers slowly aging out of the profession. She is trying to build a new force but without any promising results. Her time is spent educating the villagers about fire safety, plastering the village with passive-aggressive posters about careful handling of fire, and of course, fighting fires. She thrives as a group leader but simply lacks a team. Maybe the hero can help her in some way.

The bigfoot

A towering figure shrouded in mystery, Bigfoot is whispered about in fearful tones by the villagers, though no one is quite sure why. Beneath his three-meter frame and nocturnal habits lies a surprisingly mellow soul with two main passions: coffee and photography. He is not much for small talk, but share a drink with him and you will find a steadfast companion who can outdrink even the most seasoned bar regulars. Despite his fearsome reputation, he is more interested in capturing the perfect shot than causing a stir.

The two guards

Despite having the same goal, they couldn't be more different. One guard is a constant talker, always ready to entertain his counterpart. The second guard is a quiet fellow who, even when he wishes to talk, is constantly interrupted by the other guard. Even though they differ in a lot of ways, they agree on one thing: protecting the village and its inhabitants with all they've got. Their goal requires them to be on duty all day and night, never giving them a break. They could really use more people to aid them.

The gnome editor

Once a humble garden gnome, he now dreams of journalistic greatness, all while rooted in the flowerbed behind the gardener's shed. Determined to revive the long-forgotten local newspaper, he has enlisted a team of streetwise cats as his loyal assistants. Always eager for the latest scoop, he constantly questions the hero about their current adventures and contributions to his next article. Despite his tiny stature, he has a big heart, especially for stray cats, whom he welcomes with open arms and tiny typewriters. However, he is still in search of a photographer, as thumbs remain a hurdle for even the most enthusiastic feline staff.

The influencer

A young, passionate man eager to leave his mark on the world and be known across the lands. He tries to advertise the village and make it more tourist-friendly, often planning festivals and events. Oftentimes, in his endeavors, he gets help from his close friend, the farmer.

The mayor

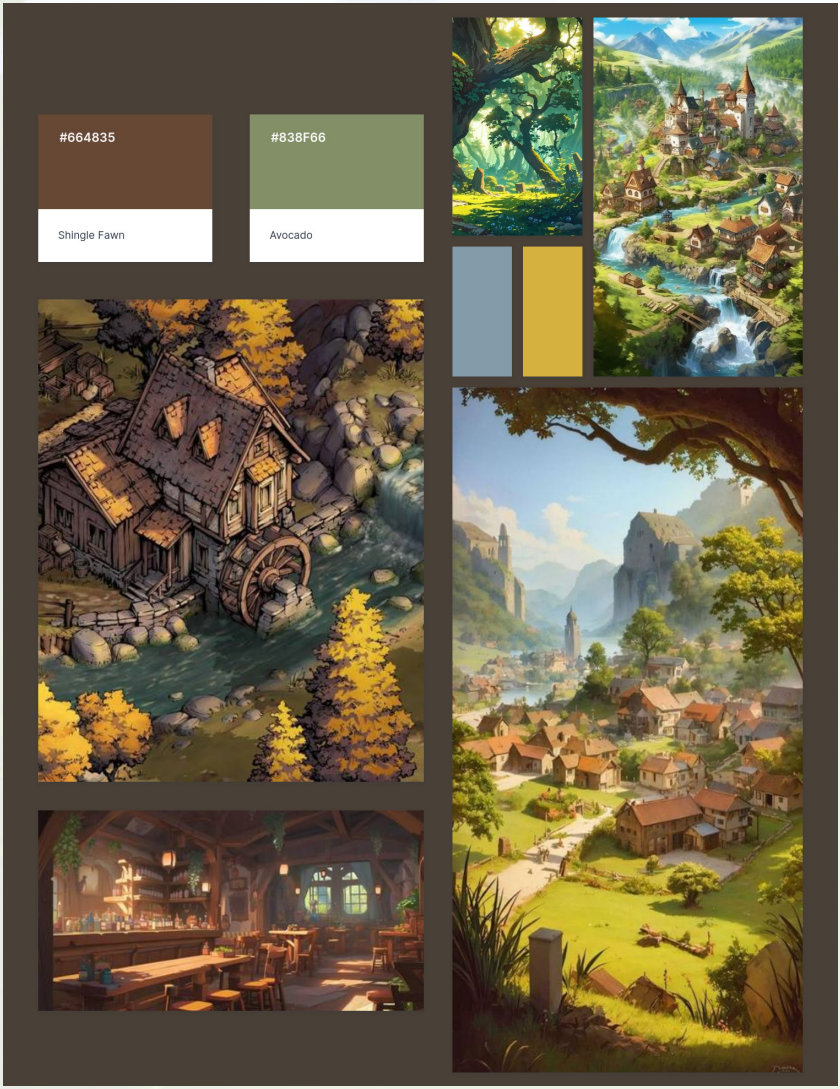
An honest man who only became mayor due to unforeseen circumstances. As a trusted painter, well beloved by everyone, he had to step up when they asked him to be a leader. Even though he prefers a simple and peaceful life, he puts in great effort to keep the village standing. He wears many hats (literally), but can't fill all the roles that are currently vacant. His requests to the hero's guild have been numerous, but are often overlooked due to more glorious quests enticing the knights.

Pending character descriptions

The alchemist
The gardener
The doctor
The pixies
The trader
The owl mayor
The teacher
The farmer
The kenku therapist
The flamboyant fish
The harengon waiter

WORLD & SETTING

Visuals of the world



Key locations

The Academy

The place in which the hero trained and spent his life until recently. A glorious place filled to the brim with paladins, knights and mages, just waiting for their next quest.

The Town

A town long past her glory days, with the population aging and more vital jobs being in danger of dying out. The remaining villagers sacrifice a lot to keep the place that they call their home standing. Even retorting to calling the academy for help.

Inspirations

Dungeon and Dragons heavily inspired the world setting. With similar creatures and monster roaming this high fantasy world.

A lot of the characters are inspired by people I know personally to pay homage to their influence in my life and how they shape me as a person.

GAMEPLAY OVERVIEW

Features

- A plethora of minigames
- An everchanging townscape, influenced by your choices
- An engaging story with complex relationships

Core Game Loop

1. Explore the town
2. Find a villager in need of help with a task
3. Do the task
4. Return to the villager
5. Find a way to make this task manageable without you
6. See the towns dynamic change

TEAM

Marina Willi

Programmer and Game Designer

Bachelor of Science - Digital Ideation (Focus Computer Science)

Sonam Faoro

Artist

Art and Design Vocational Matura

ART & STYLE

Style

- Handpainted textures
- 3D Graphics
- Cel Shading

CONCEPT ART

Thanks

This project wouldn't have been possible without the unwavering support of the people around me. I want to express a sincere thank you to everyone who believed in me and my goals.

My family
For all the countless essays that were read and corrected by my brother, and the endless mornings my mother tried to get me out of bed and helped me when I couldn't help myself.

My friends
For all the happy memories, fun jokes, and support in times when I needed it most.

My stand-up partner, Anna
For all the judging looks when I was late again and again. For being my role model while working on this project.

My mentors
For keeping me calm when my brain and I were fighting for dear life. For telling me to just do it, and for harboring enthusiasm when I lost mine.

Digital Ideation
For creating a safe space for my ideas and giving me a place in life even after graduating.

My love
For the light you gave me when it seemed darkest. For the times you left everything to console me when I was crying. For all the absolute joy you brought me when we worked on this story.

THANK YOU ALL SO MUCH <3

For further information or updates contact me

marina.willi@bluemail.ch

or follow me on:

LinkedIn: